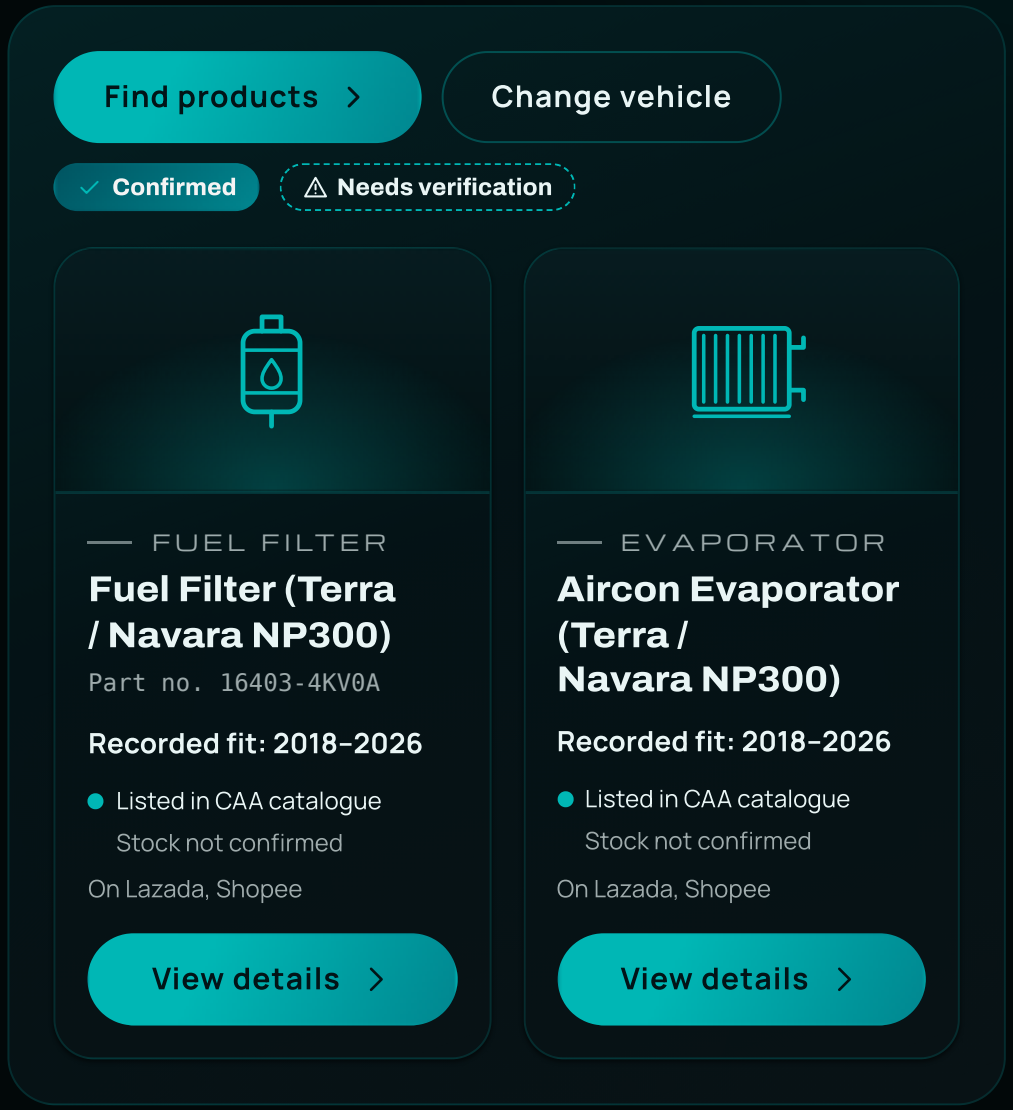
— CABALEN AUTO AIRCON · FINAL PROJECT

DESIGN SYSTEM

The rules the CAA AI Product Finder interface follows, so that every screen looks like it belongs to the same app. Every swatch, type sample and component on these pages is rendered from the app's own CSS files and React components.

REPOSITORY	github.com/Teywyl/caa-ai-product-finder
CHECKED AT	Commit 21a726c, 11 October 2026
DEFAULT THEME	Noir Showroom (dark)
TOKENS LIVE IN	`client/src/styles.css`, `designs.css`, `luxe.css`



02 Colour
03 Contrast
04 Type
05 Spacing and shape
06 Controls
07 Cards and feedback
08 Screen states
09 In code

EVERY COLOUR, ITS HEX AND ITS NAME IN CODE

Brand core styles.css :root, shared by every theme

--primary
#005461
Deep teal. Header, table heads, gradient start

--secondary
#018790
Teal. Gradient end, focused input border

--accent
#00b7b5
Aqua. Focus ring, highlights, button start

--light
#F4F4F4
Off-white. Text on teal fills

Noir surfaces designs.css [data-design='noir']

--bg
#020809
Page background

--surface-solid
#061417
Menus, cards, mobile nav

--surface-art
#071C20 → #041012
Card illustration well

--on-cta
#021417
Text on aqua buttons

Text [data-tone='dark']

--ink
#E9F5F5
Body and headings

--muted
rgba(233,245,245,.68)
= #9FA9A9 on --bg. Secondary text

--on-dark
#F4F4F4
Text on deep-teal fills

--on-dark-muted
rgba(244,244,244,.74)
Captions on dark stages

Lines and tints aqua at low opacity

--line
rgba(0,183,181,.16)
Card borders, dividers

--line-strong
rgba(0,183,181,.34)
Input and ghost-button borders

--tint
rgba(0,183,181,.06)
Hover wash

--tint-2
rgba(0,183,181,.12)
Selected rows, error wash

Gradients designs.css :root and [data-tone='dark']

--grad-cta
#00B7B5 0–32% → #018790
Primary buttons, avatar, logo mark

--grad-deep
#005461 → #018790
Confirmed badge, table head, shop tiles

--grad-text
#00B7B5 → #018790 → #00B7B5
Model variant text on the stage

Other themes same brand core, different surfaces. Picked in the design switcher

Velocity --bg / --surface-solid
#000000 / #0B0F10

Aurora --bg / --surface-solid
#01232A / #032C33

Classic --bg / --ink
#F4F4F4 / #005461

Classic --muted
rgba(0,84,97,.78)
= #367781 on #F4F4F4

There is no red. Errors use shape (a 4px left bar and an alert icon) plus words, not a warning colour, so the palette stays within the brand teals. Status never relies on colour alone: “Confirmed” and “Needs verification” differ by fill, border style (solid or dashed), icon and label.

TEXT AGAINST ITS BACKGROUND, CHECKED

THEME	USE	SAMPLE	FOREGROUND	BACKGROUND	RATIO	MINIMUM	RESULT
Noir	Body text	Aa	`--ink` #e9f5f5	`--bg` #020809	**18.10:1**	Text 4.5:1	**Pass**
Noir	Body text on cards	Aa	`--ink` #e9f5f5	`--surface-solid` #061417	**16.82:1**	Text 4.5:1	**Pass**
Noir	Secondary text	Aa	`--muted` #9fa9a9	`--bg` #020809	**8.38:1**	Text 4.5:1	**Pass**
Noir	Secondary text on cards	Aa	`--muted` #a0adae	`--surface-solid` #061417	**8.11:1**	Text 4.5:1	**Pass**
Noir	Input placeholder	Aa	`--muted at 80%` #818e90	`--surface-solid` #061417	**5.54:1**	Text 4.5:1	**Pass**
Noir	Accent text and icons	Aa	`--accent` #00b7b5	`--bg` #020809	**8.11:1**	Text 4.5:1	**Pass**
Noir	Primary button label (centre)	Aa	`--on-cta` #021417	`--grad-cta at 50%` #00aaab	**6.58:1**	Text 4.5:1	**Pass**
Noir	Confirmed badge (centre)	Aa	`--on-dark` #f4f4f4	`--grad-deep at 50%` #006e78	**5.45:1**	Text 4.5:1	**Pass**
Noir	Pressed segment	Aa	`#022a30` #022a30	`--accent` #00b7b5	**6.13:1**	Text 4.5:1	**Pass**
Noir	Focus ring		`--focus` #00b7b5	`--bg` #020809	**8.11:1**	UI 3:1	**Pass**
Noir	Focused input border		`--secondary` #018790	`--bg` #020809	**4.68:1**	UI 3:1	**Pass**
Noir	Resting input border		`--line-strong` #014443	`--bg` #020809	**1.83:1**	UI 3:1	**Fails**
Velocity	Body text	Aa	`--ink` #e9f5f5	`--bg` #000000	**18.84:1**	Text 4.5:1	**Pass**
Velocity	Secondary text on cards	Aa	`--muted` #a2abac	`--surface-solid` #0b0f10	**8.22:1**	Text 4.5:1	**Pass**
Aurora	Body text	Aa	`--ink` #e9f5f5	`--bg` #01232a	**14.78:1**	Text 4.5:1	**Pass**
Aurora	Secondary text on cards	Aa	`--muted` #adc1c3	`--surface-solid` #032c33	**7.93:1**	Text 4.5:1	**Pass**
Classic	Body text	Aa	`--ink` #005461	`--bg` #f4f4f4	**7.82:1**	Text 4.5:1	**Pass**
Classic	Secondary text	Aa	`--muted` #367781	`--bg` #f4f4f4	**4.64:1**	Text 4.5:1	**Pass**
Classic	Primary button label	Aa	`#ffffff` #ffffff	`--primary` #005461	**8.60:1**	Text 4.5:1	**Pass**
Classic	Header text	Aa	`--on-dark` #f4f4f4	`--primary` #005461	**7.82:1**	Text 4.5:1	**Pass**
Classic	Small accent label on header	Aa	`--accent` #00b7b5	`--primary` #005461	**3.46:1**	Text 4.5:1	**Fails**
Classic	Focus ring		`--focus` #018790	`--bg` #f4f4f4	**3.92:1**	UI 3:1	**Pass**

Method. WCAG 2.x luminance formula run on the token values. Transparent tokens are blended onto their background first; gradients use the colour under the label's centre. Text needs 4.5:1; borders and focus rings 3:1.

Two to fix. Noir's resting input border (1.83:1): raise `--line-strong` to about 70% aqua. Classic's small aqua label on the header (3.46:1): use `--on-dark-muted`. Classic is the older optional theme.

— TYPE

THREE FAMILIES, SIX NAMED SIZES

04

ARCHIVO
`--font-display`
Headings and model names. Variable width: Noir sets it narrow (78%), heavy (850) and uppercase.

Manrope
`--font-body`
Body text, buttons, inputs. Set in luxe.css, with Lato as the fallback.

MICHROMA
`--font-label`
Small uppercase labels only: eyebrows, table heads, field captions. Spaced 0.22em.

16403-4KV0A
`--font-mono`
Part numbers. System monospace.

`--fs-2xl`	34–60px · clamp	Display	**FIND THE RIGHT PART**
`--fs-xl`	28–36px · clamp	Page title	**NISSAN TERRA 2020**
`--fs-lg`	22px · 1.375rem	Section title	**COMPATIBLE PARTS** (AIRCON PARTS)
`--fs-md`	16px · line height 1.6	Body	Choose a vehicle and year to see only the products recorded as compatible.
`--fs-sm`	14px · 0.875rem	Small and meta	3 products for the Terra 2020 · Stock not confirmed
`--fs-xs`	12px · labels 10–11px	Caption and label	STEP 3 · Needs verification · Part no. 16403-4KV0A

Four sizes do most of the work: **xs, sm, md, lg** (12, 14, 16, 22px); xl and 2xl are for one title per screen. Count: 64 font-size declarations use the tokens, 60 are one-offs (e.g. 0.9375rem buttons, 1.125rem part names). Next clean-up: map them to the nearest token.

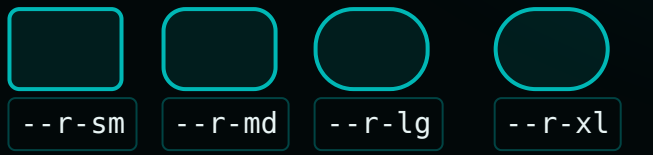
ONE SCALE: 4, 8, 12, 16, 24, 32, 48, 64

Spacing scale

--s1 to --s8, in rem

`--s1`	4px	Icon-to-text gap
`--s2`	8px	Gap inside a button
`--s3`	12px	Grid gap on phones
`--s4`	16px	Card padding, form gap
`--s5`	24px	Panel padding, section gap
`--s6`	32px	Login card padding
`--s7`	48px	Between page sections
`--s8`	64px	Bottom padding of the main area

Corner radius



`--r-sm` 6px

`--r-md` 12px

`--r-lg` 20px in Noir

`--r-xl` 30px in Noir



`pill`

999px · buttons, chips, inputs

Layout

MAX WIDTH	**1200px, centred**
GUTTER	**16 / 24 / 32px** below 720 / 720+ / 1100+
HEADER	**68px** (--header-h). Noir floats it as a pill
TOUCH SIZE	**Main controls 44–52px tall** (small buttons 38px)

Audit of the CSS

385 padding, margin and gap values: **292 use the scale**, 93 are raw (mostly 2px and 6px nudges). Rule: spacing comes from `--s1`–`--s8`; a 2px hairline is the only exception.

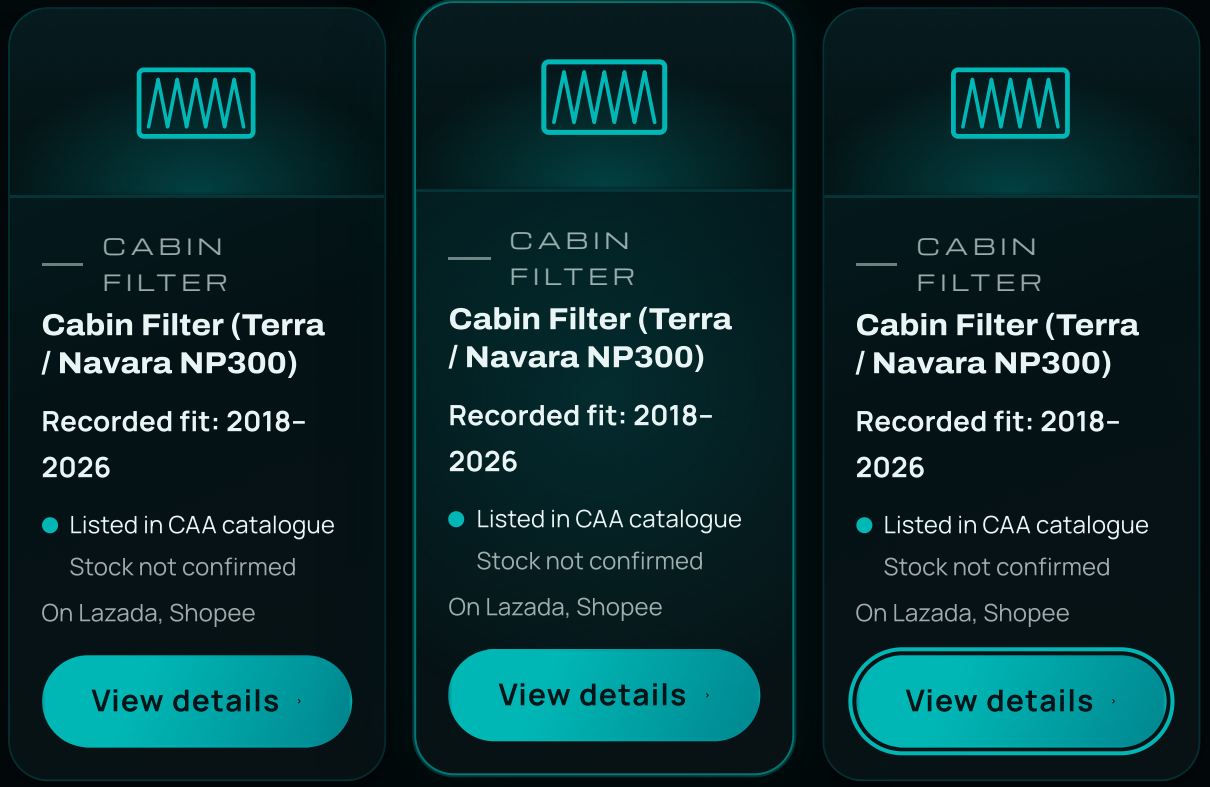
EACH CONTROL IN EVERY STATE

	DEFAULT	HOVER	FOCUSED (KEYBOARD)	DISABLED	LOADING / OTHER
Primary button `.btn--primary`	Find products	Find products	Find products	Find products	Signing in…
Ghost button `.btn--ghost`	Change vehicle	Change vehicle	Change vehicle	Save roles	*Not used*
Icon button `.icon-btn`	›	›	›	‹	*Not used*
Text input `.input`	e.g. cabin filter for Terra	e.g. cabin filter for Terra	cabin filter terra 2020	e.g. cabin filter for Terra Looks enabled. Add a style	filter Error (aria-invalid)
Year select `.year-select-input`	2020 ⌄	2020 ⌄	2020 ⌄	*Not used*	*Not used*
Chip `.chip`	Cabin filter Terra 2020	Cabin filter Terra 2020	Cabin filter Terra 2020	*Not used*	*Not used*
Text link `.link-btn`	Review in Product records	Review in Product records	Review in Product records	*Not used*	*Not used*
Tab `.tab`	Products 27	Products 27	Products 27	*Not used*	Products 27 Selected

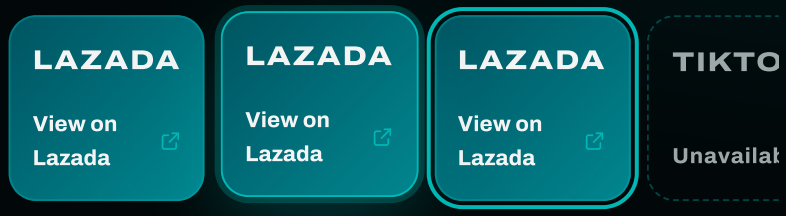
Focus is never removed without a replacement. Every control gets a 2px `--focus` outline, offset 2px (aqua in Noir, 8.1:1 against the page). Text inputs swap it for an aqua border plus a 3px glow, and the year select uses a 3px offset. Loading buttons are disabled, show a spinner and change their label (“Signing in…”), so they can’t be pressed twice.

REUSABLE PIECES THAT SHOW RESULTS

Part card .part-card · default, hover, button focused



Shop tile .market · link, hover, focus, unavailable

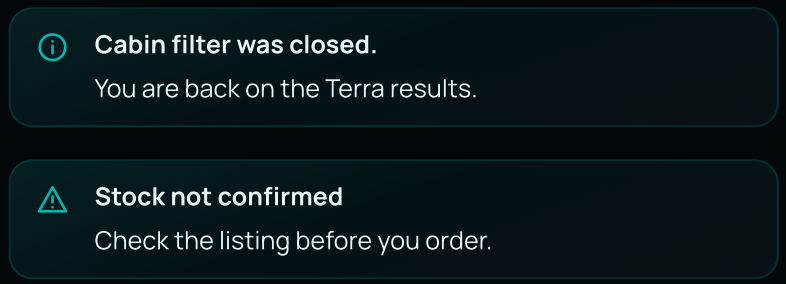


Fit status badges

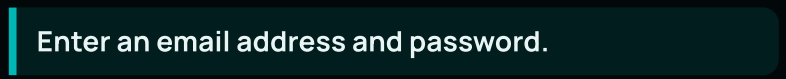


Solid fill + check vs dashed border + alert icon

Notices .notice--info / --warn / --error



Inline field error



LOADING, EMPTY, ERROR AND DATA, DECIDED ONCE

LOADING One bordered row: spinner + what is happening. role="status". No skeletons.

COMPATIBLE PARTS (AIRCON PARTS)

Finding compatible parts…

EMPTY Dashed box, icon, a plain-language title, the reason, and a way forward.

COMPATIBLE PARTS (AIRCON PARTS)

No confirmed products for this vehicle and year.

Other years of the Terra have confirmed products. Try a different year.

Change year | Change vehicle

ERROR Notice with role="alert": what failed, the server's message, and Try again.

COMPATIBLE PARTS (AIRCON PARTS)

⚠ **Could not load compatible parts.**
The server did not respond. Check your connection and try again.

Try again

DATA Card grid: 1 column on phones, 2 above 380px, 3 above 900px.

COMPATIBLE PARTS (AIRCON PARTS)

3 products for the Terra 2020



Cabin Filter (Terra / Navara NP300)



Fuel Filter (Terra / Navara NP300)



Aircon Evaporator (Terra / Navara NP300)

Every screen reuses `<Loading>`, `<EmptyState>` and `<LoadError>` from `components/ui.jsx`; no page styles these states itself.

WHERE THESE LIVE, AND WHY

Where the rules live

FILE	HOLDS
`client/src/styles.css`	All tokens as CSS custom properties on `:root` (colour, type, spacing, radius, shadow, easing) and every component class (`.btn`, `.input`, `.part-card`, `.empty` …).
`client/src/designs.css`	Theme layers. `[data-tone='dark']` remaps the text and line tokens. `[data-design='noir']`, `velocity`, `aurora` and `classic` set surfaces, radius and title style.
`client/src/luxe.css`	Finishing layer: the Manrope and Michroma font tokens, label style, card spotlight, button shine.
`client/src/data/designs.js`	The theme list and `DEFAULT_DESIGN = 'noir'`. AppState writes `data-design` and `data-tone` onto `<html>`.
`client/src/components/ui.jsx`	Shared React pieces: Notice, EmptyState, Loading, LoadError, StatusBadge, PartCard, MarketTile, YearSelect.

Why plain CSS custom properties. It is the template's starting point, it needs no build step, and themes are just a different set of values on one attribute. Components only ever read `var(--token)`, so switching theme never touches component code.

How a component reads tokens

```
/* styles.css */
:root {
  --secondary: #018790;
  --accent:    #00b7b5;
  --s2: 0.5rem;  --s5: 1.5rem;
  --focus: var(--secondary);
}
:focus-visible {
  outline: 2px solid var(--focus);
  outline-offset: 2px;
}
.btn {
  gap: var(--s2);
  padding: 0 var(--s5);
  min-height: 46px;
  border-radius: 999px;
}

/* designs.css: dark themes */
[data-tone='dark'] {
  --ink: #e9f5f5;
  --focus: #00b7b5;
}
[data-design='noir'] { --bg: #020809; }
```

Rules to keep

- New colours, sizes or spacing go in as a token first, never as a raw value in a component.
- Every interactive element keeps a visible `:focus-visible` style.
- Animations respect `prefers-reduced-motion`; the global rule already cuts them to 1ms.
- Open fixes: input border contrast, a `.input:disabled` style, and mapping the one-off font sizes to the scale.